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Sensor module and weight exercise apparatus including the same

Abstract

Provided is a weight exercise apparatus. The weight exercise apparatus includes an exercise main body in which movement is generated according to a user's weight exercise, a sensor module configured to detect movement of the exercise main body, and a processor configured to control a user interface (UI) unit to display a UI element indicating an exercise state of a user corresponding to the detected movement on a UI screen wherein the sensor module includes a first laser sensor configured to irradiate a first laser beam toward the weight plate or a component moving together with the weight plate to detect a moving distance of the weight plate when the weight plate moves and a second laser sensor configured to irradiate a second laser beam toward a component that does not move in spite of movement of the weight plate when the weight plate moves.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) This application is based on and claims priority under 35 U.S.C. § 119 to Korean Patent Application No. 10-2021-0190356, filed on Dec. 28, 2021 and Korean Patent Application No. 10-2022-0151983, filed on Nov. 14, 2022, in the Korean Intellectual Property Office, the disclosures of which are incorporated by reference herein in their entireties.

BACKGROUND

1. Field

(2) The disclosure relates to a sensor module and a weight exercise apparatus including the same.

2. Description of the Related Art

(3) Generally, as the standard of living improves, interest in health is gradually increasing, and thus many people use various types of weight exercise apparatuses to improve physical strength.

(4) The weight exercise apparatuses have been provided in various forms depending on a body part to be improved in muscular strength, a purpose of use, etc., and are intended to train an upper body and a lower body mainly using hands or feet. Various types of weight exercise apparatuses, such as shoulder presses, bench presses, abdominal machines, butterfly machines, arm curl machines, etc., have been used depending on the body part to be improved in its muscle strength.

(5) The weight exercise apparatus is installed such that a plurality of weight plates in a block form overlap each other, and the weight exercise apparatus may include a pin structure for selecting some of the plurality of weight plates. A user may use the pin structure to select the number of weight plates or a weight of a weight plate to be lifted. The user may exercise by moving a selected weight through an exercise structure of exercise equipment.

(6) However, when exercising using a weight exercise apparatus, the user may have a difficulty in accurately identifying an exercise state and may not be given exact motivation such as an exercise goal, making it difficult to expect improvement in the exercise effect.

SUMMARY

(7) To improve the user's exercise effect, an apparatus may be considered which may identify an exercise state such as an exercise speed, an exercise amount, etc., during an exercise of the user or after termination of the exercise of the user. As an example for this end, adoption of a sensor module to measure the exercise state of the user and a user interface unit to display information measured by the sensor module may be considered.

(8) However, when measurement of the sensor module is incorrect, the user's exercise state may not be accurately identified, actually lowering the user's motivation.

(9) Provided are a sensor module capable of accurate measurement to efficiently guide a user's weight exercise and a weight exercise apparatus including the sensor module.

(10) Additional aspects will be set forth in part in the description which follows and, in part, will be apparent from the description, or may be learned by practice of the presented embodiments of the disclosure.

(11) According to an aspect of the disclosure, a weight exercise apparatus includes an exercise main body including a plurality of weight plates which are movable, a sensor module configured to

detect movement of a weight plate of the exercise main body, a user interface (UI) unit configured to output a UI screen, a memory storing at least one instruction, and a processor configured to control the UI unit to display a UI element indicating an exercise state of a user corresponding to the detected movement on the UI screen, by executing the at least one instruction, in which the sensor module includes a first laser sensor configured to irradiate a first laser beam toward the weight plate or a component moving together with the weight plate to detect a moving distance of the weight plate when the weight plate moves and a second laser sensor configured to irradiate a second laser beam toward a component that does not move in spite of movement of the weight plate when the weight plate moves.

(12) The first laser sensor may be arranged to irradiate the first laser beam toward a pin structure for weight setting of the weight exercise apparatus.

(13) The first laser sensor may be arranged to irradiate the first laser beam toward a top surface of the weight plate.

(14) The second laser sensor may be installed on the exercise main body.

(15) The exercise main body may further include a frame structure supporting the plurality of weight plates to allow the plurality of weight plates to move, and the second laser sensor may be arranged to irradiate the second laser beam toward a fixed region in the frame structure.

(16) The processor may be further configured to control the UI unit to display the UI element on the UI screen according to information detected by the first laser sensor based on whether a position of the weight plate moves, by executing the at least one instruction.

(17) The processor may be further configured to, by executing the at least one instruction, determine a compensation factor by calculating an amount of change of a second detected distance detected by the second laser sensor and determine a position of the weight plate by reflecting the determined compensation factor in a first detected distance detected by the first laser sensor.

(18) When surrounding environmental conditions of the sensor module change, a first detected distance detected by the first laser sensor may change and a second detected distance detected by the second laser sensor may change, and a change rate of the first detected distance of the first laser sensor may be equal to a change rate of the second detected distance of the second laser sensor.

(19) When surrounding environmental conditions of the sensor module change, a first detected distance detected by the first laser sensor may change and a second detected distance detected by the second laser sensor may change, and an amount of change of the first detected distance of the first laser sensor may be equal to an amount of change of the second detected distance of the second laser sensor.

(20) The surrounding environmental conditions may include an ambient temperature or an ambient humidity of the sensor module.

(21) The first laser sensor and the second laser sensor may have identical specifications.

(22) The first laser sensor and the second laser sensor may have an identical measurement accuracy.

(23) According to another aspect of the disclosure, a sensor module to detect movement of a measurement target includes a first laser sensor configured to irradiate a first laser beam toward the measurement target or a component moving together with the measurement target to measure movement of the measurement target when the measurement target moves and a second laser sensor configured to irradiate a second laser beam toward a component that does not move in spite of movement of the measurement target when the measurement target moves.

(24) According to another aspect of the disclosure, a weight exercise apparatus includes an exercise main body including a plurality of weight plates which are movable, a sensor module configured to detect movement of a weight plate of the exercise main body, a user interface (UI) unit configured to output a UI screen, a memory storing at least one instruction, and a processor configured to control the UI unit to display a UI element indicating an exercise state of a user corresponding to the detected movement on the UI screen, by executing the at least one instruction, in which the

sensor module includes a single laser sensor, the laser sensor including a first sensing mode in which a laser beam is irradiated toward the weight plate or a component moving together with the weight plate to detect a moving distance of the weight plate when the weight plate moves and a second sensing mode in which a laser beam is irradiated toward a component that does not move in spite of movement of the weight plate when the weight plate moves.

(25) The laser sensor may be configured to be movable, and a position in which a laser beam is irradiated in the first sensing mode may be different from a position in which a laser beam is irradiated in the second sensing mode.

(26) The laser sensor may be further configured to irradiate a laser beam in a specific direction, the sensor module may further include a reference plate movable between an interference position interfering with an irradiation path of the laser beam and a deviation position deviating from the irradiation path of the laser beam, the laser sensor may have the first sensing mode when the reference plate is in the deviation position, and the laser sensor may have the second sensing mode when the reference plate is in the interference position.

(27) The exercise main body may further include a frame structure that moves the plurality of weight plates to allow the plurality of weight plates to move and has a fixed region that does not move when the weight plate moves, the laser sensor may be further arranged to irradiate a laser beam toward a pin structure for weight setting of the weight exercise apparatus and to irradiate the laser beam toward the fixed region when the pin structure is separated from the weight plate, and the laser sensor may have the first sensing mode when irradiating the laser beam to the pin structure, and may have the second sensing mode when irradiating the laser beam to the fixed region.

(28) A distance between the fixed region and the laser sensor may be defined as a reference distance, and the processor may be further configured to switch the laser sensor from the first sensing mode to the second sensing mode when a distance detected by the laser sensor corresponds to the reference distance.

(29) Other aspects, features, advantages, and advantages other than those described above will become apparent from the following figures, claims, and the detailed description of the disclosure.

(30) These general and specific aspects may be carried out using a system, a method, a computer program, or any combination of thereof.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The above and other aspects, features, and advantages of certain embodiments of the disclosure will be more apparent from the following description taken in conjunction with the accompanying drawings, in which:

(2) FIG. 1 is a perspective view for describing a weight exercise apparatus according to an embodiment;

(3) FIG. 2 is a view for describing a structure for setting a weight of a weight exercise apparatus according to an embodiment;

(4) FIG. 3 is a block diagram of a weight exercise apparatus according to an embodiment;

(5) FIG. 4 is a view for describing an example of a sensor module of a weight exercise apparatus according to an embodiment;

(6) FIG. 5 is a view for describing an operation of a first laser sensor of a sensor module of a weight exercise apparatus according to an embodiment;

(7) FIG. 6 is a view for describing an example of a sensor module of a weight exercise apparatus according to an embodiment;

(8) FIG. 7 shows a user interface (UI) screen output on a UI unit of a weight exercise apparatus

according to an embodiment;

(9) FIG. **8** conceptually shows an example of a sensor module according to an embodiment;

(10) FIG. **9** is a graph showing a change of a second detected distance detected by a second laser sensor according to an embodiment;

(11) FIG. **10** is a view for describing a result of compensating for a measurement error of a first detected distance in a sensor module according to an embodiment;

(12) FIG. **11** is a block diagram of a weight exercise apparatus according to another embodiment;

(13) FIGS. **12** and **13** are views for describing an example of a sensor module including a single laser sensor;

(14) FIGS. **14** and **15** are views for describing another example of a sensor module including a single laser sensor;

(15) FIG. **16** is a view for describing another example of a sensor module including a single laser sensor;

(16) FIGS. **17** and **18** are views for describing an example of a sensor module including a single laser sensor; and

(17) FIG. **19** is a view for describing a smart gym environment provided with a weight exercise apparatus according to an embodiment of the disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(18) Reference will now be made in detail to embodiments, examples of which are illustrated in the accompanying drawings, wherein like reference numerals refer to like elements throughout. In this regard, the present embodiments may have different forms and should not be construed as being limited to the descriptions set forth herein. Accordingly, the embodiments are merely described below, by referring to the figures, to explain aspects of the present description.

(19) Hereinafter, various embodiments will be described in detail with reference to the drawings. Embodiments described below may be changed into various different forms and performed. To more clearly describe characteristics of the embodiments, a detailed description of matters widely known to those of ordinary skill in the art to which the following embodiments belong will be omitted.

(20) Meanwhile, throughout the specification, when any component is “connected” to another component, it may include not only a case where they are ‘directly connected’, but also a case where they are ‘electrically connected with another component therebetween’. When a component “includes” another component, it may mean that the component may further include other components rather than excluding the other component, unless stated otherwise.

(21) In addition, terminology, such as ‘first’ or ‘second’ used herein, can be used to describe various components, but the components should not be limited by the terms. These terms are used to distinguish one component from another component.

(22) The term used herein such as ‘unit’, ‘module’, etc., indicates a unit for processing at least one function or operation, and may be implemented in hardware, software, or in a combination of hardware and software.

(23) Current embodiments relate to a weight exercise apparatus and a sensor module used therefor, and matters widely known to those of ordinary skill in the art to which the following embodiments belong will not be described in detail.

(24) FIG. **1** is a perspective view for describing a weight exercise apparatus **1** according to an embodiment, and FIG. **2** is a view for describing a structure for setting a weight of the weight exercise apparatus **1** according to an embodiment. FIG. **3** is a block diagram of the weight exercise apparatus **1** according to an embodiment.

(25) Referring to FIGS. **1** to **3**, the weight exercise apparatus **1** may include an exercise main body **2**, a sensor module **100**, a user interface (UI) unit **3**, and a processor **4**.

(26) The exercise main body **2** may be exercise equipment in which movement is generated according to a user's weight exercise. For example, the exercise main body **2** may include a

plurality of weight plates **21** and a frame structure **23** supporting the plurality of weight plates **21** to allow the plurality of weight plates **21** to move. The frame structure **23** may support the weight plate **21** such that the weight plate **21** may move in a gravity direction and a direction opposite thereto, e.g., up and down.

(27) Referring to FIG. 2, the exercise main body **2** may include a pin structure **25** for selecting at least some of the plurality of weight plates **21**. The pin structure **25** may be inserted into a pin hole **211** to select the weight plate **21** corresponding to a weight desired by a user. The pin hole **211** may be formed by the adjacent weight plate **21**. However, arrangement of the pin hole **211** may not be limited thereto and may be various. For example, the pin hole **211** may be formed in each weight plate **21**.

(28) The pin structure **25** may include an insertion region **251** to be inserted into the pin hole **211** and a holder region **253** fixed to the insertion region **251**. The insertion region **251** of the pin structure **25** may have a shape corresponding to the shape of the pin hole **211**. The holder region **253** may include a cylindrical portion **2531** having a constant diameter in an extending direction of the pin structure **25** and a slope portion **2533** extending from the cylindrical portion **2531** and having a diameter changing in an extending direction thereof. However, the shape of the holder region **253** may not be limited thereto and may be changed into various shapes as long as they allow the user to insert the pin structure **25** into the pin hole **211** or remove the pin structure **25** from the pin hole **211**.

(29) As the insertion region **251** of the pin structure **25** is inserted into the pin hole **211** of the certain weight plate **21**, a weight of the certain weight plate **21** into which the pin structure **25** is inserted and a weight of the weight plate **21** arranged on the certain weight plate **21** may be selected.

(30) The plurality of weight plates **21** may be sequentially stacked in a vertical direction. Each of the plurality of weight plates **21** may have a weight. Weights of the plurality of weight plates **21** may be respectively equal to or different from one another. For example, the weights of the plurality of weight plates **21** may be respectively equal to about 5 kg. In another example, some of the plurality of weight plates **21** may have a weight of about 5 kg, respectively, and the others of the plurality of weight plates **21** may have a weight of about 10 kg, respectively. In addition, the weights of the plurality of weight plates **21** may be various.

(31) The frame structure **23** may include a base frame **231** and a pair of guide rails **233** that extend in the vertical direction to allow the plurality of weight plates **21** to move up and down and are installed on the base frame **231**. The pair of guide rails **233** may be arranged to penetrate the plurality of weight plates **21**. The frame structure **23** may include a connection line **235** configured to deliver a force applied by the user to the weight plate **21**.

(32) In the weight exercise apparatus **1** according to an embodiment, the user may apply a force to an exercise structure **26** to move the weight plate **21** corresponding to the selected weight in a direction opposite to the gravity direction or in the gravity direction. The exercise structure **26** may be implemented in various forms depending on a body part for which the user is to exercise. The form of the exercise structure **26** is widely known and thus will not be described in detail.

(33) The weight exercise apparatus **1** according to an embodiment may further include a component to measure the user's exercise state and feed a result back in the exercise main body **2**. For example, the weight exercise apparatus **1** may include a sensor module **100**, a UI unit **3** outputting a UI screen, a memory **5** storing at least one instruction, and a processor **4** controlling the UI unit **3**.

(34) The UI unit **3** may include an input unit for receiving an input to operate the exercise equipment, an input to set the exercise apparatus, etc., from the user and an output unit for displaying information such as an exercise state, an exercise result, etc. For example, the UI unit **3** may have, but not limited to, a form of a touch screen.

(35) The processor **4** may manage information for managing various functions provided by the

weight exercise apparatus **1** or the user's exercise state, by executing at least one instruction stored in the memory **5**. The exercise state of the user may include the number of times or a duration the user exercises, an exercise level, an exercise speed, a trajectory of a body of the user, etc. The processor **4** may include at least one processing modules. For example, the processor **4** may include at least one of a central processing unit (CPU), a microprocessor, a graphical processing unit (GPU), application specific integrated circuits (ASICs), a digital signal processor (DSP), and field programmable gate arrays (FPGAs).

(36) The processor **4** may control the other components included in the weight exercise apparatus **1** to perform a function corresponding to a user input received through the UI unit **3**. The processor **4** may execute instructions, a software module, or a program stored in the memory **5**, read data or a file stored in the memory **5**, or store a new program or application in the memory **5**.

(37) The memory **5** may store at least one instructions. The processor **4** may correspond to an example of a computer capable of executing instructions stored in the memory **5**. The memory **5** may store instructions, a software module, or a program. The memory **5** may include at least one of a random access memory (RAM), a static random access memory (SRAM), a read-only memory (ROM), a flash memory, an electrically erasable programmable read-only memory (EEPROM), a programmable read-only memory (PROM), a magnetic memory, a magnetic disk, and an optical disk.

(38) The memory **5** may store a UI module and an exercise management module therein. The UI module and the exercise management module may be software modules or programs including at least one instructions and may correspond to a part of another program. The processor **4** may load the UI module and the exercise management module from the memory **5** and execute corresponding instructions.

(39) The UI module may include an UI input/output module and an UI configuration module. The UI input/output module may identify a user's input with respect to a UI screen displayed on the UI unit **3**, and control an output of a UI element generated or changed in the UI configuration module. The UI configuration module may generate or change a UI element to be displayed on the UI unit **3** based on information identified by the exercise management module, the UI unit **3**, the sensor module **110**, etc.

(40) The exercise management module may include an exercise process setting module and an exercise state identification module. The exercise process setting module may set an exercise process suitable for the user based on information about the user when the user who is to use the weight exercise apparatus **1** is identified. For example, the exercise process setting module may receive exercise process information from a smart gym server **200** through a communication interface unit **6** and set an exercise process corresponding to the identified user. The exercise state identification module may generate the user's exercise state information and generate information indicating a progress of the exercise process reflecting the user's exercise state or information indicating the exercise result, based on movement of the exercise equipment, received through the sensor module **100**. The sensor module **100** of the exercise state identification module may deliver the generated information to the UI module or record the generated information in the memory **5**.

(41) The communication interface unit **6** may perform wired/wireless communication with another device or a network. To this end, the communication interface unit **6** may include a communication module supporting at least one of various wired/wireless communication methods. For example, communication modules that perform short-range communications such as Wireless Fidelity (Wi-Fi), various types of mobile communications such as 3rd-Generation (3G), 4th-Generation (4G), 5th-Generation (5G), etc., or ultra-wideband communications, or communications modules that perform wired communications using coaxial cables, optical cables, etc., may be included, and without being limited thereto, various types of communication modules according to the development of communication technology may be included. The communication interface unit **6** may be connected to a device located outside the weight exercise apparatus **1** to transmit and

receive a message including a signal or data. The weight exercise apparatus **1** may communicate with the smart gym server **200**, a user terminal in a form such as a wearable device, a smart phone, etc., or a manager terminal **300** (see FIG. **19**) in a form such as a personal computer (PC), a laptop computer, a smart phone, etc., through the communication interface unit **6**.

(42) FIG. **4** is a view for describing an example of the sensor module **100** of the weight exercise apparatus **1** according to an embodiment. FIG. **5** is a view for describing an operation of a first laser sensor **110** of the sensor module **100** of the weight exercise apparatus **1** according to an embodiment.

(43) Referring to FIGS. **3** to **5**, the sensor module **100** may be configured to detect movement of a measurement target, e.g., the weight plate **21**. For example, the sensor module **100** may include the first laser sensor **110** configured to detect a moving distance of the weight plate **21** when the weight plate **21** moves. The first laser sensor **110** may irradiate a first laser beam **L1** toward the weight plate **21** or a component moving together with the weight plate **21**. For example, the first laser sensor **110** may irradiate the first laser beam **L1** to the pin structure **25** and receive the first laser beam **L1** reflected from the pin structure **25** to detect a position of the pin structure **25**. The position of the weight plate **21** may be detected from the position of the pin structure **25**.

(44) However, arrangement and configuration of the first laser sensor **110** may not be limited thereto, and may be changed variously as long as they allow movement of the weight plate **21** to be detected directly or indirectly. For example, as shown in FIG. **6**, the first laser sensor **110A** may be arranged to irradiate the first laser beam **L1** to a top surface of the weight plate **21**. In another example, although not shown, for detection of the position of the weight plate **21**, the first laser sensor **110** may be arranged to detect movement of a connection line **235** (see FIG. **1**) or an angle of a pulley (not shown) that changes a direction of the connection line **235**.

(45) The sensor module **100** may sense movement of the weight plate **21** or a manipulation unit that a user's body contacts based on a result of detection by the first laser sensor **110**, and obtain sensing data corresponding to the sensed movement. The sensing data may have a form of a time, a distance, a depth, an image, etc.

(46) FIG. **7** shows a UI screen output on the UI unit **3** of the weight exercise apparatus **1** according to an embodiment.

(47) Referring to FIGS. **3** and **7**, based on the foregoing configuration, the processor **4** may control the UI unit **3** to display a UI element indicating a user's exercise state corresponding to movement of the weight exercise apparatus **1** detected by the sensor module **100** on the UI screen, by executing at least one instruction stored in the memory **5**. The processor **4** may control the UI unit **3** to display a second UI element indicating an exercise guide recommended in an exercise using the weight exercise apparatus **1**, together with the UI element, on the UI screen.

(48) As such, the user of the weight exercise apparatus **1** may recognize the user's exercise state by using data (or information) displayed on the UI screen. In this way, the user may exercise efficiently.

(49) The sensor module **100** may further include a function of detecting weight setting of the exercise main body **2**. The processor **4** may control the UI unit **3** to display information **31** indicating the weight setting of the exercise main body **2** detected by the sensor module **100** on the UI screen.

(50) The weight exercise apparatus **1** according to an embodiment may be exposed to various surrounding environmental conditions. For example, the sensor module **100** of the weight exercise apparatus **1** may be exposed to various surrounding environmental conditions. For example, the surrounding environmental conditions of the sensor module **100** of the weight exercise apparatus **1** may vary depending on season, weather, and indoor environment. In another example, the surrounding environmental conditions of the sensor module **100** of the weight exercise apparatus **1** may change with a state of a peripheral part, e.g., a printed circuit board (PCB).

(51) In the weight exercise apparatus **1**, the first laser sensor **110** of the sensor module **100** may

have a measurement error depending on a change of the surrounding environmental conditions. The surrounding environmental conditions may include at least one of ambient temperature and ambient humidity. The surrounding environmental conditions may include a state of an electronic part of the weight exercise apparatus **1**, e.g., a PCB. For example, when at least one of the ambient temperature, ambient humidity, and the electronic part of the weight exercise apparatus **1** changes, a first detected distance **D1** detected by the first laser sensor **110** may change. For example, the first detected distance **D1** of the first laser sensor **110** with respect to the weight plate **21** located at the same distance may be different when the ambient temperature changes. As such, the first laser sensor **110** may have a measurement error according to a change in the surrounding environmental conditions.

(52) Such a measurement error may result in degradation of reliability of information detected by the sensor module **100**. This may lead to incorrect feedback on the exercise state of the user.

(53) In a way to compensate for the measurement error, an influence of the surrounding environmental conditions may be removed from a value detected by the first laser sensor **110**.

(54) However, the first laser sensor **110** is a sensor for detecting the moving weight plate **21**, such that the first detected distance **D1** may change in real time with movement of the weight plate **21**. The amount of change of the first detected distance **D1** detected by the first laser sensor **110** includes the amount of change with movement of the weight plate **21** as well as the amount of change occurring according to the change in the surrounding environmental conditions, making it difficult to identify the amount of change occurring according to the change in the surrounding environmental conditions from the amount of change of the first detected distance **D1** detected by the first laser sensor **110**.

(55) FIG. **8** conceptually shows an example of the sensor module **100** according to an embodiment. FIG. **9** is a graph showing a change of a second detected distance **D2** detected by the second laser sensor **100** according to an embodiment.

(56) Referring to FIG. **8**, the sensor module **100** according to an embodiment may further include a second laser sensor **120** exposed to the same surrounding environmental conditions as the first laser sensor **110**. In this way, the sensor module **100** may compensate for a measurement error of the first laser sensor **110** without designing complex software.

(57) The second laser sensor **120** may irradiate a second laser beam **L2** toward a component that does not move regardless of movement of the weight plate **21** when the weight plate **21** moves. As an example for this end, the second laser sensor **120** may irradiate the second laser beam **L2** toward a region that is installed on the exercise main body **2** and does not move on the exercise main body **2**. For example, the second laser sensor **120** may be arranged to irradiate the second laser beam **L2** toward a fixed region **2310** in the frame structure **23** supporting the plurality of weight plates **21** to allow the plurality of weight plates **21** to move. In another example, although not shown, the second laser sensor **120** may be arranged to irradiate the second laser beam **L2** to a fixed region outside the weight exercise apparatus **1**.

(58) As such, the second laser sensor **120** may irradiate the second laser beam **L2** toward the fixed region **2310** that does not move. The second laser sensor **120** may be arranged to measure a preset reference distance **Dr**.

(59) The second laser sensor **120** measures the reference distance **Dr**, such that the second detected distance **D2** detected by the second laser sensor **120** may be uniform when the surrounding environment conditions are constant. The second detected distance **D2** detected constant may be the reference distance **Dr**. In another example, the reference distance **Dr** may be a predetermined distance.

(60) As the surrounding environmental conditions change, the second detected distance **D2** detected by the second laser sensor **120** may become different from the reference distance **Dr**. From a distance between the reference distance **Dr** and the second detected distance **D2**, the amount of change occurring according to the surrounding environmental conditions may be estimated.

Moreover, a time **t1** at which a change in the surrounding environmental conditions starts may be estimated.

(61) The first laser sensor **110** and the second laser sensor **120** may have the same specifications. For example, the first laser sensor **110** and the second laser sensor **120** may have the same measurement accuracy. Thus, the measurement error of the first laser sensor **110** occurring according to the change in the surrounding environmental conditions may correspond to the measurement error of the second laser sensor **120** occurring according to the change in the surrounding environmental conditions.

(62) For example, by calculating the amount of change of the second detected distance **D2** of the second laser sensor **120**, a compensation factor may be determined. Thus, by reflecting the determined compensation factor in the first detected distance **D1** of the first laser sensor **110**, the position of the weight plate **21** may be determined.

(63) In an example, a change rate of the second detected distance **D2** of the second laser sensor **120** may correspond to a change rate of the first detected distance **D1** of the first laser sensor **110**. For example, the change rate of the second detected distance **D2** of the second laser sensor **120** may be the same as the change rate of the first detected distance **D1** of the first laser sensor **110**. Based on the change rate of the second detected distance **D2**, the measurement error of the first detected distance occurring according to the change in the surrounding environmental conditions may be compensated for.

(64) For example, the position of the weight plate **21** may be determined by considering the change rate of the second detected distance **D2** in the first detected distance **D1**. For example, the compensation factor may be determined by calculating the change rate of the second detected distance **D2**, and the position of the weight plate **21** may be determined by reflecting the determined compensation factor in the first detected distance **D1**.

(65) For example, as the ambient temperature of the weight exercise apparatus **1** changes by 5 degrees (° C.), the second detected distance **D2** detected by the second laser sensor **120** may change from about 500 mm to about 450 mm. In this case, the change rate of the second detected distance **D2** may be calculated as about -10%. The compensation factor for compensating for the measurement error may be determined as about $10/9$ ($=100\%/(100\%-10\%)$). In this case, when the first detected distance **D1** detected by the first laser sensor **110** is about 900 mm, the position of the weight plate **21** may be determined as about 1000 mm ($=900\text{ mm} \times 10/9$) by multiplying the first detected distance **D1** by the compensation factor.

(66) In another example, the amount of change of the second detected distance **D2** of the second laser sensor **120** may correspond to the amount of change of the first detected distance **D1** of the first laser sensor **110**. For example, the amount of change of the second detected distance **D2** of the second laser sensor **120** may be the same as the amount of change of the first detected distance **D1** of the first laser sensor **110**. Based on the amount of change of the second detected distance **D2**, the measurement error of the first detected distance occurring according to the change in the surrounding environmental conditions may be compensated for.

(67) For example, the position of the weight plate **21** may be determined by considering the amount of change of the second detected distance **D2** in the first detected distance **D1**. For example, the compensation factor may be determined by calculating the amount of change of the second detected distance **D2**, and the position of the weight plate **21** may be determined by reflecting the determined compensation factor in the first detected distance **D1**.

(68) For example, as the ambient temperature of the weight exercise apparatus **1** changes by 5 degrees (° C.), the second detected distance **D2** detected by the second laser sensor **120** may change from about 500 mm to about 450 mm. In this case, the amount of change of the second detected distance **D2** may be calculated as about -50 mm. The compensation factor for compensating for the measurement error may be determined as about +50 mm or a value obtained by multiplying about +50 mm by a decimal or an integer. For example, the compensation factor

may be determined as about +50 mm. In this case, when the first detected distance **D1** detected by the first laser sensor **110** is about 900 mm, the position of the weight plate **21** may be determined as about 950 mm (=900 mm+50 mm) by adding the compensation factor to the first detected distance **D1**.

(69) FIG. **10** is a view for describing a result of compensating for a measurement error of the first detected distance **D1** in the sensor module **100** according to an embodiment. (a) of FIG. **10** shows the first detected distance **D1** detected by the first laser sensor **110**, (b) of FIG. **10** shows the second detected distance **D2** detected by the second laser sensor **120**, and (c) of FIG. **10** shows a position **D** of the weight plate **21** determined by compensating for the measurement error in the first detected distance **D1**.

(70) Referring to FIG. **10**, a surrounding environmental condition, e.g., the temperature may change from a first time **t1** to a second time **t2**, and after the second time **t2**, the changed temperature may be maintained. In this case, referring to (a) of FIG. **10**, the first detected distance **D1** detected by the first laser sensor **110** changes at the first time **t1**, but there is no way to identify whether the change of the first detected distance **D1** results from a change of an exercise pattern of the user or a change in the surrounding environmental conditions. On the other hand, referring to (b) of FIG. **10**, the second laser sensor **120** is arranged to detect the specific reference distance **Dr**, such that the processor may determine from the change of the second detected distance **D2** at the first time **t1** that the change of the first detected distance results from the change in the surrounding environmental conditions.

(71) Thus, the processor may calculate the amount of change of the second detected distance **D2** and determine the compensation factor based on the calculated amount of change. By reflecting the compensation factor to the first detected distance **D1**, the position **D** of the weight plate **21** may be compensated for as shown in (c) of FIG. **10**. As the surrounding environmental conditions change, the compensation factor may change from the first time **t1** to the second time **t2**, and as the surrounding environmental conditions maintain a new state, the compensation coefficient may be constant from the second time **t2**.

(72) Meanwhile, in the above-described embodiment, a description has been made mainly of an example where the sensor module **100** includes the plurality of laser sensors **110** and **120**.

However, a sensor module of a weight exercise apparatus according to an embodiment is not limited thereto, and may also be implemented with a single laser sensor.

(73) FIG. **11** is a block diagram of a weight exercise apparatus according to another embodiment.

(74) Referring to FIG. **11**, a weight exercise apparatus according to an embodiment may include the exercise main body **2**, a sensor module **100A**, the UI unit **3**, the memory **5**, and the processor **4**. In the current embodiment, a description will be made mainly of a difference from the above-described embodiments and a description of the same matter will be omitted.

(75) The sensor module **100A** according to an embodiment may include a single laser sensor **101**. The laser sensor **101** may include a first sensing mode and a second sensing mode.

(76) In the first sensing mode, the laser sensor **101** may irradiate a laser beam **L** to detect a moving distance of the weight plate **21** when the weight plate **21** moves. For example, in the first sensing mode, the laser sensor **101** may irradiate the laser beam **L** toward the weight plate **21** or a component moving together with the weight plate **21**.

(77) In the second sensing mode, the laser sensor **101** may irradiate the laser beam **L** toward a component that does not move regardless of movement of the weight plate **21** when the weight plate **21** moves. For example, in the second sensing mode, the laser sensor **101** may irradiate the laser beam **L** toward a member or a region having a fixed position, regardless of movement of the weight plate **21**.

(78) FIGS. **12** and **13** are views for describing an example of the sensor module **100A** including the single laser sensor **101**.

(79) Referring to FIGS. **12** and **13**, on the sensor module **100A** according to an embodiment, the

laser sensor **101** may be rotatable. As the laser sensor **101** rotates, an irradiation direction of the laser beam L may change.

(80) In the laser sensor **101**, a direction in which the laser beam L is irradiated in the first sensing mode may be different from a direction in which the laser beam L is irradiated in the second sensing mode.

(81) Referring to FIG. **12**, the laser sensor **101** may be arranged to irradiate the laser beam L toward the pin structure **25** in the first sensing mode. The laser sensor **101** may receive the laser beam L reflected from the pin structure **25** and detect the position of the pin structure **25**. The position of the weight plate **21** may be detected from the position of the pin structure **25**.

(82) However, arrangement of the laser sensor **101** is not limited thereto, such that the arrangement may be changed variously as long as it is intended to irradiate the laser beam L toward the weight plate **21** or a component moving together with the weight plate **21**.

(83) The sensor module **100A** may sense movement of the weight plate **21** or a manipulation unit that a user's body contacts based on a result of detection by the laser sensor **101** in the first sensing mode, and obtain sensing data corresponding to the sensed movement. The sensing data may have a form of a time, a distance, a depth, an image, etc.

(84) By executing at least one instructions stored in the memory **5**, the UI unit **3** may be controlled to display a UI element indicating the user's exercise state corresponding to movement of the weight exercise apparatus **1** detected by the sensor module **100A** to be displayed on the UI screen.

(85) Referring to FIGS. **12** and **13**, the laser sensor **101** may move to switch from the first sensing mode to the second sensing mode. For example, the laser sensor **101** may rotate to switch from the first sensing mode to the second sensing mode. To switch from the first sensing mode to the second sensing mode, the laser sensor **101** may rotate in a counterclockwise direction. On the other hand, to switch from the second sensing mode to the first sensing mode, the laser sensor **101** may rotate in a clockwise direction. A position to which the laser beam L is irradiated when the laser sensor **101** is in the first sensing mode may be different from a position to which the laser beam L is irradiated when the laser sensor **101** is in the second sensing mode. For example, a direction in which the laser beam L is irradiated when the laser sensor **101** is in the first sensing mode may be different from a direction in which the laser beam L is irradiated when the laser sensor **101** is in the second sensing mode.

(86) The processor **4** may periodically rotate the laser sensor **101** such that the laser sensor **101** periodically switches to the first sensing mode and the second sensing mode.

(87) When the laser sensor **101** is in the second sensing mode, the laser beam L may be irradiated toward the frame structure **23** or a fixed region **2310A** in a peripheral member thereof. The fixed region **2310A** may be a member with a fixed position regardless of movement of the weight plate **21** when the weight plate **21** moves.

(88) The position of the fixed region **2310A** is fixed, and the position of the laser sensor **101** has a constant position in the second sensing mode thereof, such that a space between the fixed region **2310A** and the laser sensor **101** in the second sensing mode may be constant. When the laser sensor **101** is in the second sensing mode, the preset reference distance D_r may be measured.

(89) Thus, the amount of change occurring due to the surrounding environment conditions may be estimated from a difference between the second detected distance D_2 detected in the second sensing mode of the laser sensor **101** and the reference distance D_r .

(90) The processor **4** may determine the compensation factor by calculating the amount of change of the second detected distance D_2 of the laser sensor **101** in the second sensing mode. Thus, by reflecting the determined compensation factor in the first detected distance D_1 of the laser sensor **101** in the first sensing mode, the position of the weight plate **21** may be determined.

(91) However, a component for implementing a plurality of sensing modes through the single laser sensor **101** in the sensor module **100A** is not limited thereto, and may be various. While rotation is described as an example of movement of the laser sensor **101** in the above-described embodiments,

movement of the laser sensor **101** is not limited thereto. For example, although not shown, the laser sensor **101** may move in a horizontal direction. In this case, the laser sensor **101** may have a position overlapping the pin structure **25** in the first sensing mode and a position not overlapping the pin structure **25** in the second sensing mode.

(92) FIGS. **14** and **15** are views for describing another example of the sensor module **100A** including the single laser sensor **101**. Referring to FIGS. **14** and **15**, in the sensor module **100A** according to an embodiment, the laser sensor **101** is fixed without rotating and an absolute position of a fixed region may not be fixed on every axis.

(93) For example, the laser sensor **101** may irradiate the laser beam L toward the weight plate **21** or a component moving together with the weight plate **21**. For example, the laser sensor **101** may be arranged to irradiate the laser beam L toward the pin structure **25**.

(94) The sensor module **100A** may further include a reference plate **2310B** movable with respect to the laser sensor **101**. The reference plate **2310B** may move between an interference position **2311** interfering with an irradiation path of the laser beam L and a deviation position **2312** deviating from the irradiation path of the laser beam L. For example, the reference plate **2310B** may move in a direction perpendicular to the irradiation direction of the laser beam L of the laser sensor **101**.

(95) When the reference plate **2310B** is at the deviation position **2312**, the laser sensor **101** may be in the first sensing mode. The sensor module **100A** may sense movement of a manipulation unit the weight plate **21** or a user's body contacts based on a result of detection by the laser sensor **101** in the first sensing mode, and obtain sensing data corresponding to the sensed movement. The sensing data may have a form of a time, a distance, a depth, an image, etc.

(96) When the reference plate **2310B** is at the interference position **2311**, the laser sensor **101** may be in the second sensing mode. When the reference plate **2310B** is at the interference position **2311**, a distance between the reference plate **2310B** and the laser sensor **101** may be constant. For example, a space between the reference plate **2310B** at the interference position **2311** and the laser sensor **101** may be constant. When the laser sensor **101** is in the second sensing mode, the preset reference distance D_r may be measured.

(97) Thus, the amount of change occurring due to the surrounding environment conditions may be estimated from a difference between the second detected distance D_2 detected in the second sensing mode of the laser sensor **101** and the reference distance D_r .

(98) The processor **4** may determine the compensation factor by calculating the amount of change of the second detected distance D_2 of the laser sensor **101** in the second sensing mode. Thus, by reflecting the determined compensation factor in the first detected distance D_1 of the laser sensor **101** in the first sensing mode, the position of the weight plate **21** may be determined.

(99) In the above-described embodiment, a description has been made of an example where the reference plate **2310B** has a structure movable with respect to the laser sensor **101** in the horizontal direction. However, the movable structure of the reference plate **2310B** is not limited thereto. For example, as shown in FIG. **16**, a reference plate **2310B1** may have a structure tiltable around a predetermined axis. Thus, the reference plate **2310B1** may have the interference position **2311** or the deviation position **2312** according to a tilting angle of the reference plate **2310B1**.

(100) FIGS. **17** and **18** are views for describing an example of the sensor module **100A** including the single laser sensor **101**. Referring to FIGS. **17** and **18**, in the weight exercise apparatus according to an embodiment, the exercise main body may include the frame structure **23** supporting the plurality of weight plates **21** to allow the plurality of weight plates **21** to move. The frame structure **23** may include the fixed region **2310B** that does not move when the weight plate **21** moves.

(101) The laser sensor **101** may be arranged to irradiate the laser beam L toward the pin structure **25** for weight setting of the weight exercise apparatus. The laser sensor **101** may irradiate the laser beam L toward the fixed region **2310B** of the frame structure **23** when the pin structure **25** is separated from the weight plate **21**.

(102) The laser sensor **101** according to an embodiment may have the first sensing mode when irradiating the laser beam **L** to the pin structure **25** and may have the second sensing mode when irradiating the laser beam **L** to the fixed region **2310B**.

(103) The pin structure **25** may move together when the weight plate **21** moves, whereas the fixed region **2310B** may have a position fixed regardless of movement of the weight plate **21**. A distance between the fixed region **2310B** and the laser sensor **101** may be defined as the reference distance **Dr**.

(104) The processor **4** may switch the laser sensor **101** from the first sensing mode to the second sensing mode when the distance **D2** detected by the laser sensor **101** corresponds to the reference distance **Dr**. The processor **4** may switch the laser sensor **101** from the second sensing mode to the first sensing mode when the distance **D2** detected by the laser sensor **101** does not correspond to the reference distance **Dr**. Thus, the sensor module **100A** according to an embodiment may compensate for an error by using the second sensing mode each time when the user separates the pin structure **25** from the weight plate **21**.

(105) FIG. **19** is a view for describing a smart gym environment provided with the weight exercise apparatus **1** according to an embodiment of the disclosure.

(106) Referring to FIG. **19**, a plurality of weight exercise apparatuses **1A**, **1B**, **1C**, and **1N** are connected to a smart gym server **200** through a network. A manager such as a health trainer or a smart gym director may access the smart gym server **200** through a manager terminal **300**.

(107) Each of users **USER A**, **USER B**, **USER C**, and **USER N** coming to exercise at a smart gym may enter the smart gym after verifying an identify thereof using a user terminal such as a wearable device, a smart phone, etc., when entering and exiting the smart gym. For example, the user may enter or exit the smart gym after member verification by tagging the user terminal to an unmanned terminal such as a kiosk at the entrance of the smart gym in a near field communication (NFC) or radio frequency identification (RFID) manner. Information about a user whose membership has been verified may be transmitted from the smart gym server **200** to at least one of the weight exercise apparatuses **1A**, **1B**, **1C**, and **1N** through the network.

(108) When the user accesses any one of the weight exercise apparatuses **1A**, **1B**, **1C**, and **1N** to tag a wearable device to the corresponding weight exercise apparatus **1**, then the corresponding weight exercise apparatus **1** may automatically set an exercise program customized to an ability level and an exercise performance history of the user based on information received from the smart gym server **200**.

(109) The smart gym server **200** may store user information of a plurality of users, device information of the weight exercise apparatuses **1A**, **1B**, **1C**, and **1N**, and information used to operate other facilitates or the smart gym.

(110) When the manager such as a health trainer registers the exercise program customized to the user in the manager terminal **300**, exercise process information stored in the smart gym server **200** may be updated. The weight exercise apparatuses **1A**, **1B**, **1C**, and **1N** may receive the exercise process information from the smart gym server **200** connected through the network. Meanwhile, in the above-described embodiment, a shoulder press for strengthening a shoulder has been described as an example of the exercise main body **2**, but any exercise equipment for weight exercises may be applied variously, without being limited thereto.

(111) In the sensor module **100** according to the above-described embodiment, the weight plate **21** of the weight exercise apparatus **1** has been described as an example of a measurement target. However, an application target of the sensor module **100** according to an embodiment is not limited thereto, and the sensor module **100** may also be applied to other measurement objects than the weight plate **21**. That is, the sensor module **100** according to the disclosure is intended to detect movement of a measurement target, and may include the first laser sensor **110** to irradiate the first laser beam **L1** toward the measurement target or the component moving together with the measurement target to measure movement of the measurement target when the measurement target

moves, and the second laser sensor 120 to irradiate the second laser beam L2 toward a component that does not move regardless of movement of the measurement target when the measurement target moves.

(112) An embodiment of the disclosure may be implemented in the form of a computer program executable on a computer through various components, and the computer program may be recorded on a computer-readable medium. The medium may include a hardware device specially configured to store and execute a program instruction, like a magnetic medium such as a hard disk, a floppy disk, and a magnetic tape, an optical recording medium such as a CD-ROM and a DVD, a magneto-optical medium such as a floptical disk, ROM, RAM, flash memory, etc. Moreover, the medium may include intangible media implemented in a form transmittable on a network, and may be, for example, a medium implemented in the form of software or an application that may be transmitted and distributed through a network.

(113) Meanwhile, the computer program may be a program command specially designed and configured for the disclosure or a program command known to be used by those skilled in the art of the computer software field. Examples of the computer program may include not only a machine language code created by a compiler, but also a high-level language code executable by a computer using an interpreter.

(114) With the weight exercise apparatus and the sensor module used therein according to an embodiment of the disclosure, it is possible to perform accurate measurement to efficiently guide a user's weight exercise with a low price-burden.

(115) It should be understood that embodiments described herein should be considered in a descriptive sense only and not for purposes of limitation. Descriptions of features or aspects within each embodiment should typically be considered as available for other similar features or aspects in other embodiments. While one or more embodiments have been described with reference to the figures, it will be understood by those of ordinary skill in the art that various changes in form and details may be made therein without departing from the spirit and scope of the disclosure as defined by the following claims.

Claims

1. A weight exercise apparatus comprising: an exercise main body comprising a plurality of weight plates which are movable; a sensor module configured to detect movement of a weight plate of the plurality of weight plates; a user interface unit configured to output a user interface screen; a memory storing at least one instruction; and a processor configured to control the user interface unit to display a user interface element indicating an exercise state of a user corresponding to detected movement on the user interface screen, by executing the at least one instruction, wherein the sensor module comprises: a first laser sensor configured to irradiate a first laser beam toward the weight plate or a component moving together with the weight plate to detect a first distance of the weight plate when the weight plate moves; and a second laser sensor configured to irradiate a second laser beam toward a component that does not move in spite of movement of the weight plate when the weight plate moves, measure a reference distance between the component that does not move and the second laser sensor at a first time point, and measure a second distance between the component that does not move and the second laser sensor at a second time point that is different from the first time point, and wherein the processor is further configured to, by executing the at least one instruction, compensate a measurement error in the first distance detected by the first laser sensor caused by surrounding environmental conditions based on an amount of change or a change rate between the reference distance and the second distance.

2. The weight exercise apparatus of claim 1, wherein the second laser sensor is installed on the exercise main body.

3. The weight exercise apparatus of claim 2, wherein the exercise main body further comprises a

frame structure supporting the plurality of weight plates to allow the plurality of weight plates to move, and the second laser sensor is arranged to irradiate the second laser beam toward a fixed region in the frame structure.

4. The weight exercise apparatus of claim 1, wherein the processor is further configured to control the user interface unit to display the user interface element on the user interface screen according to information detected by the first laser sensor based on whether a position of the weight plate moves, by executing the at least one instruction.

5. The weight exercise apparatus of claim 4, wherein the processor is further configured to compensate the measurement error in the first distance detected by the first laser sensor, by executing the at least one instruction, to: determine a compensation factor by calculating the amount of change between the reference distance and the second distance detected by the second laser sensor; and determine a position of the weight plate by reflecting the determined compensation factor in the first distance detected by the first laser sensor.

6. The weight exercise apparatus of claim 1, wherein when the surrounding environmental conditions of the sensor module change, the first distance detected by the first laser sensor changes, and a change rate of the first distance detected by the first laser sensor is equal to a change rate between the second distance and the reference distance detected by the second laser sensor.

7. The weight exercise apparatus of claim 1, wherein when the surrounding environmental conditions of the sensor module change, the first distance detected by the first laser sensor changes, and an amount of change of the first distance detected by the first laser sensor is equal to the amount of change between the second distance and the reference distance detected by the second laser sensor.

8. The weight exercise apparatus of claim 1, wherein the first laser sensor and the second laser sensor have identical specifications.

9. The weight exercise apparatus of claim 8, wherein the first laser sensor and the second laser sensor have an identical measurement accuracy.

10. The weight exercise apparatus of claim 1, wherein the first laser sensor is arranged to irradiate the first laser beam toward a pin structure for weight setting of the weight exercise apparatus.

11. The weight exercise apparatus of claim 1, wherein the first laser sensor is arranged to irradiate the first laser beam toward a top surface of the weight plate.

12. The weight exercise apparatus of claim 6, wherein the surrounding environmental conditions comprise an ambient temperature or an ambient humidity of the sensor module.

13. A system to detect movement of a measurement target, the system comprising: a sensor module comprising: a first laser sensor configured to irradiate a first laser beam toward the measurement target or a component moving together with the measurement target to measure a first distance of the measurement target when the measurement target moves; and a second laser sensor configured to: irradiate a second laser beam toward a component that does not move in spite of movement of the measurement target when the measurement target moves to measure a reference distance between the component that does not move and the second laser sensor at a first time point, and a second distance between the component that does not move and the second laser sensor at a second time point that is different from the first time point, a memory storing at least one instruction; and a processor configured to, by executing the at least one instruction, compensate a measurement error in the first distance measured by the first laser sensor caused by surrounding environmental conditions based on an amount of change or a change rate between the reference distance and the second distance.
